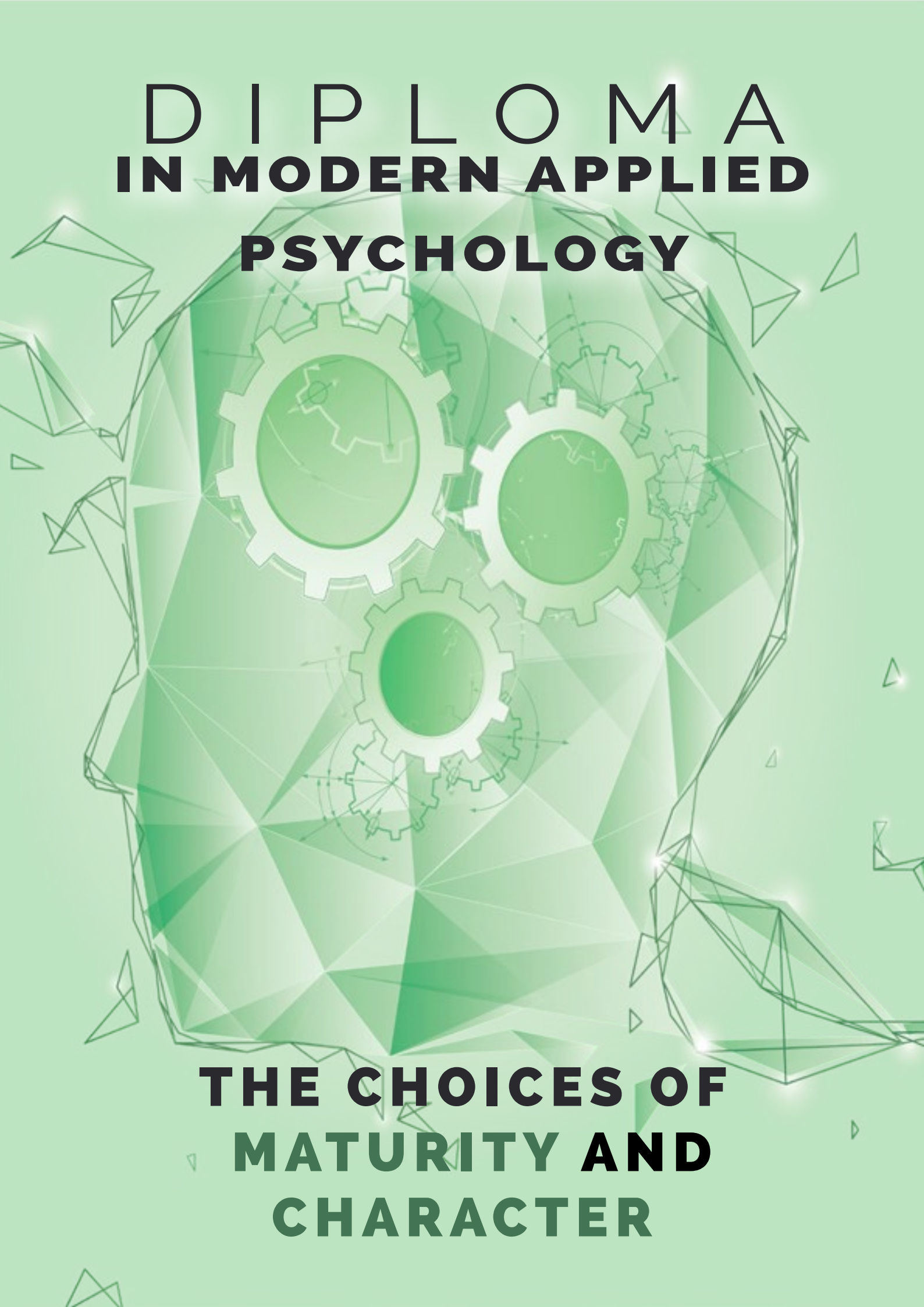


The background is a vibrant green with a complex, abstract geometric pattern. It features a large, central, multi-faceted shape resembling a crystal or a stylized head. Overlaid on this are three interlocking gears of different sizes, rendered in a lighter green. The entire design is composed of various triangles and lines, creating a sense of depth and complexity.

DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

THE CHOICES OF MATURITY AND CHARACTER

CHOICES OF MATURITY & CHARACTER

The only thing we have control over in life is how we choose to respond and react to situations in life. Life is lived inside out, not outside in. Our emotional and mental well-being isn't in the hands of our external circumstances: we choose how to react. Some people need to create noise in their lives because peace scares them. When we have quietness and peace in our lives, it suddenly forces us into a state of self-awareness and reflection.

Those who seek chaos and noise demonstrate their unwillingness to deal with their problems. The only way problems can serve us is if we own them and we learn how to deal with them in an effective, mindful and responsible way. It all comes down to the way we respond to our external environment.

This workbook is designed to take you through the choices we all face when growing in maturity and character. Through having a deep awareness of our current choices, we can be mindful of the decisions we make in the future and how that can impact our way of living.

Take some time to explore the choices of maturity and character that were highlighted in the video lecture by answering the following questions:

Responsibility vs Irresponsibility

The greatest realisation we can come to in life is that we're flawed human beings: we're imperfect in every single way and that's okay. While you are not responsible for having imperfections, you can take responsibility for making intentional improvements and becoming better. When we become aware of the extent of the choices we have and how we choose to respond to those circumstances, we can choose to either take responsibility or be irresponsible and pass the buck on to someone else.

Q. Is your natural inclination to take responsibility for other people who refuse to take responsibility for themselves?

Q. In what ways could you take less responsibility for others to encourage them to step up and start taking more responsibility for themselves?

Q. What would change in your life if you started to take less responsibility for other people's problems?



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Humility & Honesty vs Arrogance and Pride

Humility is taking responsibility for the part that we play in a given situation. It's the understanding that whilst we are imperfect human beings, we can take responsibility for the mistakes we make along life's journey. Arrogance and pride are the tools of the coward.

Q. Are there times where you haven't taken responsibility for the role you've played in a situation and the outcomes that followed?

Q. How do you think the outcome would have changed had you taken responsibility?

Q. In what ways do you think your life would change if you took responsibility for your imperfections?

Slow to Anger vs Easily Angered

Those who are slow to anger have the maturity to accept that there is a large part of themselves which they cannot, and will never, understand; meaning that they know even less about other people and circumstances. Because they cannot possibly know all the possible circumstances surrounding a situation which threatens to anger them, they choose not to become emotionally lead and instead analyse the validity of their anger before expressing it.

Q. Can you recall the last time you were angry? Write down what triggered your anger and how you handled your anger; how was your anger expressed and were you proud of how it was expressed?

Q. Ideally, how do you wish you had responded? What would you have done differently?

A Promoter of Utility vs Promoter of Disunity

When it comes to being a promoter of unity, we want to consider the labels and judgements that we've given other people (for example, through generalisations) and how we typically respond to people who are different from us.

Below you'll find a list of words. Many are controversial, however, they are all social labels. What this exercise is designed to do is help you to become more mindful of your emotional responses to these labels. As you go through this exercise, try not to judge yourself for the feeling you associate with each word. It's important just to be honest.



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WORD	FEELING
SJW	
FATHER	
QUEER	
CONSERVATIVE	
CATHOLIC	
STUDENT	
ATHEIST	
REPUBLICAN	
MOTHER	
CHRISTIAN	
LAWYER	
MUSLIM	
DEMOCRAT	
JEWISH	
PAEDOPHILE	
TERRORIST	
RAPIST	
SOLDIER	
RELIGIOUS FUNDAMENTALISM	
ORTHODOX	
BROTHER	
WHORE	
SISTER	

Q. Are you committed to working with and understanding other people, or are you more interested in doing things your own way?

Q. What changes can you begin making today to better understand others and begin working with other people?

A Desire for Growth & Development vs Desire to Feel Happy & Constantly Gratified

Pleasure, happiness and gratification are temporary fulfilling, but they leave us feeling unfulfilled in the long term. Growth is permanent and comes about only through taking full ownership for all our experiences, including the consequences of our decisions.

Q. Consider situations in your life where you have chosen to resist growth through the desire for pleasure or instant gratification?



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Reflect back on times when you were aware of what you 'should' be doing but maybe chose to spend time doing something more enjoyable or fun.

Q. In those situations, how did you feel about your decision to do something for pleasure as opposed to committing to your own personal growth?

Consider how you felt before making the decision during and afterwards. Often tricking ourselves into experiencing something enjoyable in the short term can lead us to us feeling sad or unfulfilled later on.

Q. Let's reverse the same scenario. Consider a time where you made a sacrifice and decided to focus on doing something that was going to help you progress in life?

Think of as many experiences as you can and write them down. They don't always have to be a big decision. It could be a little thing like working later instead of going out with friends or choosing to go to sleep earlier because you know rest is important.

Q. The next time you are finding yourself resisting growth and embracing the desire for pleasure, what is one action step you can take to get yourself back on track?

Note: This doesn't mean you can't have downtime and enjoy yourself. This is about taking responsibility for the times we procrastinate or resist growing as individuals often through fear.

Faith for the Future vs Fear for the Future

When we choose active faith, we're more inclined to make decisions. Active faith means taking action and responsibility for the outcome knowing that you've made decisions based on your best judgement in the present moment.

Many of us are concerned with what other people think and feel about us. We base our decisions on what they want and what we think they want. Understanding these fears will empower you to step forward and make decisions based on the life you want and what's right for you.

Q. What fears are you holding onto which are preventing you from having faith in the decisions you're making?



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Q. Do you take risks with the faith that things will work out for the best, or do you tend to 'play it safe' due to the fear of making mistakes?

Q. How much more could you achieve with your life if you were to stop exercising fear and start exercising more faith?

Decisive & Progress Driven vs Undriven & Double-Minded

Indecisiveness and procrastination represent a lack of trust within ourselves and our own judgement. Consider and reflect back on the limiting beliefs that are currently stopping you from moving forward.

Q. What are the limiting beliefs preventing you from making a decision?

Q. How different would your life be if you let go of these limiting beliefs and trusted in your own decision-making abilities?

Q. Do you embrace challenges and look for ways to grow and develop yourself, or do you shy away from change?

Q. What areas of your life could you start improving in today which would prioritise growth over pleasure?

Governed by Facts vs Governed by Feelings

People who are governed by feelings are usually up and down like a yo-yo. They respond emotionally to other people and circumstances and are often inconsistent because they become completely overwhelmed by their feelings at times. Other people will find it difficult to trust them because these inconsistencies make it hard for them to know where they stand.



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Those who are governed by facts are more grounded in who they are. Whilst they will still have emotional ups and downs, they are not emotionally led. Their security is grounded in who they are, which means that they become mature, consistent, decisive and strong.

Q. Being really honest with yourself, how many social, work and intimate relationships do you have in your life that are based upon facts?

Q. How do you feel the quality of your relationships would change if you chose to be transparent and honest in them?

Often we don't say things because we don't want to hurt the other person's feelings. But by not speaking up, we're not being honest and this can also end up hurting the other person and causing strain on the relationship.

Q. Think of someone that you can reach out to and be completely honest about a concern you have in your relationship with them. Write one or more names down then reach out to them and have that conversation.

